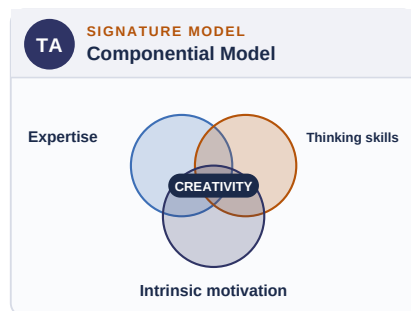


Teresa Amabile

The Componential Model & the Social Psychology of Creativity

b. 1950 · Edsel Bryant Ford Professor Emerita · Harvard Business School



"You can kill creativity far more easily than you can build it."

"Of all the things that can boost inner work life, the most important is making progress in meaningful work."

1 WHY THIS THINKER MATTERS

How do you get more creativity out of the people you already have? Amabile answers the manager's real question: creativity is not a fixed gift but a variable you can raise or crush through the work environment you design. Her research is where creativity stops being mystical and becomes manageable.

2 INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

American social psychologist. Professor Emerita at Harvard Business School, formerly at Brandeis. She pioneered the experimental study of creativity in real organisational settings and, with Steven Kramer, the large-scale diary study behind the 'progress principle'.

3 FRAMEWORKS · TOOLS · MODELS

NAME	WHAT IT IS
Componential Model	Expertise × creative-thinking skills × intrinsic motivation
Intrinsic Motivation Principle	People are most creative when driven by interest, not pressure
Creativity-killers	Surveillance, harsh evaluation, over-control, competition
The Progress Principle	Small wins in meaningful work fuel inner work life
Componential Theory of Org. Creativity	Environment amplifies or suppresses the three components

4 HOW IT'S OPERATIONALIZED

- Diagnose which component (expertise, skills, motivation) limits a team
- Audit the environment for creativity-killers before blaming people
- Protect intrinsic motivation from the wrong incentives and surveillance
- Design for daily progress on meaningful work, not just outcomes
- Match rewards to the type of task to avoid crowding out interest

6 ENDURING IMPACT

- Foundational reference for creativity management
- 'How to Kill Creativity' among HBR's most-cited creativity articles
- Shifted the field from the genius to the environment

5 LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUES

- Intrinsic-motivation emphasis debated for highly extrinsic contexts
- Componential model is descriptive, not strongly predictive
- Much early evidence from lab and student tasks
- Less guidance on team- vs individual-level dynamics
- Cultural generalisability of motivation findings contested

SELECTED WORKS

CREATIVITY IN CONTEXT <i>Update to the Social Psychology of Creativity</i> AMABILE · 1996	THE PROGRESS PRINCIPLE <i>with Steven Kramer</i> AMABILE · 2011	HOW TO KILL CREATIVITY <i>Harvard Business Review</i> AMABILE · 1998	THE SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY OF CREATIVITY <i>Springer</i> AMABILE · 1983
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REFERENCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Amabile, T.M. (1998) 'How to Kill Creativity', *Harvard Business Review*, 76(5), pp. 76–87.